MILITARY STANDARD

VISUAL INSPECTION STANDARDS FOR SMALL ARMS AMMUNITION

THROUGH CALIBER .50

TO ALL HOLDERS OF MIL-STD-636:

1. THE FOLLOWING PAGES OF MIL-STD-636 HAVE BEEN REVISED AND SUPERSEDE THE PAGES LISTED:

NEW PAGE	DATE	SUPERSEDED PAGE	DATE
15	5 June 1958	15	Reprinted Without Change
16	15 August 1988	16	5 June 1958
17	15 August 1988	17	5 June 1958
17a	15 August 1988	(New Page)	15 August 1988
17b	15 August 1988	(New Page)	15 August 1988
18	5 June 1958	18	Reprinted Without Change

2. RETAIN THIS NOTICE AND INSERT BEFORE TABLE OF CONTENTS.

3. Holders of MIL-STD-636 will verify that page changes and additions indicated above have been entered. This notice page will be retained as a check sheet. This issuance, together with appended pages, is a separate publication. Each notice is to be retained by stocking points until the military standard is completely revised or cancelled.

Custodians:
Army - AR
Navy - OS

Preparing Activity:
Army - AR

(Project 1305-0C63)

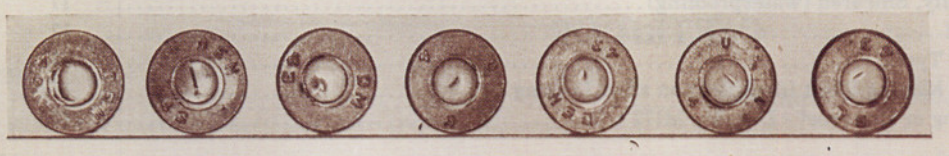
DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

AMSC N/A

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T07:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

No. 35. Loose Primer (Not illustrated)
Major

A cartridge is to be counted as a defective because of a loose primer if the primer can be moved within the primer pocket or if the primer can be shaken or jarred from the pocket.



a b c d e f g

[— — — — — — Minor — — — — — —] [— — — Permissible — — —]

No. 36a. Nicked or Dented Primer

(a) Deformed Primer.
(b) Nick extending to edge of primer cup.
(c-d-e-f-g) Small Nicks and Dents.



a b c d e f g

[— — — — — — Minor — — — — — —] [— — — Permissible — — —]

No. 36b. Nicked or Dented Primer



[Minor] [— — — Permissible — — —]

No. 37. No Waterproofing
(Primer pocket joint)



[— — — — Minor — — — —] [— — Permissible — —]

No. 38. Defective Crimp

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T07:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

LIST OF DEFECTS

NATO CALIBER 7.62-MM

CARTRIDGE

No.		Page
1.	Discolored, Dirty, Oily, Smeared (waterproofing)	17
2.	Corroded or Stained	17
3.	Mixed Ammunition Types	17
3a.	Missing or Partially Missing Paint Identification after Linking	17a
3b.	Identification Missing or Incorrect - Dummy M172	17b

CASE

4.	Round Head	17b
5.	Dent (case)	18
6.	Split Case	18
7.	Perforated Case	19
8.	Draw Scratch	19
9.	Scratch (case)	19
10.	Beveled Underside of Head	20
11.	Case Mouth not Crimped in Cannelure	20
12.	Scaly Metal (case)	20
13.	No Chamfer on Head (rim)	21
14.	Fold	21
15.	Wrinkle	21
16.	Buckle	22
17.	Bulge	22
18.	Illegible or Missing Head Stamp	22
19.	Defective Head	22, 23
20.	Defective Mouth	23
21.	No Visible Evidence of Mouth Anneal	23

BULLET

22.	Dent (bullet)	24
23.	Scratch (bullet)	24
24.	Split Bullet Jacket	24
25.	Loose Bullet	24
26.	Missing Cannelure	24
27.	Scaly Metal (bullet)	24
28.	Upset (crooked) Point	25
29.	Exposed Steel (clad jacket)	25
30.	Blunt Point	25
31.	Defective Cannelure	25

PRIMER

32.	No Primer	25
33.	Cocked Primer	25
34.	Inverted Primer	25
35.	Loose Primer	26
36.	Nicked or Dented Primer	26
37.	No Waterproofing (Primer pocket joint)	26
38.	Defective Crimp	26

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 20261O-26T07:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.



a b c d e f g h i

[— — — — — — — — — Minor — — — — — — — — — —] [— — — — — — Permissible — — — — — —]

No. 1. Discolored, Dirty, Oily, Smeared (waterproofing)

(a) } Smeared Identification
(b) } Paint
(c) Smeared Primer Waterproofing
(d) Oil on Cartridge Case
(e) Dirty Cartridge Case
(f) Smeared Primer Waterproofing
(g) } Discolored Cartridge
(h) } Cases
(i) Dirty Cartridge Case



[— — — — — Major — — — — —] [Permissible]

No. 2. Corroded or Stained

Where etching appears in stained areas, local or general, the cartridge will be classified as a major defective.

No. 3. Mixed Ammunition Types (Not illustrated). Critical, Major, or Minor depending on types mixed. See detail specification. (Also includes incorrect or poor identification.)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T07:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.



a

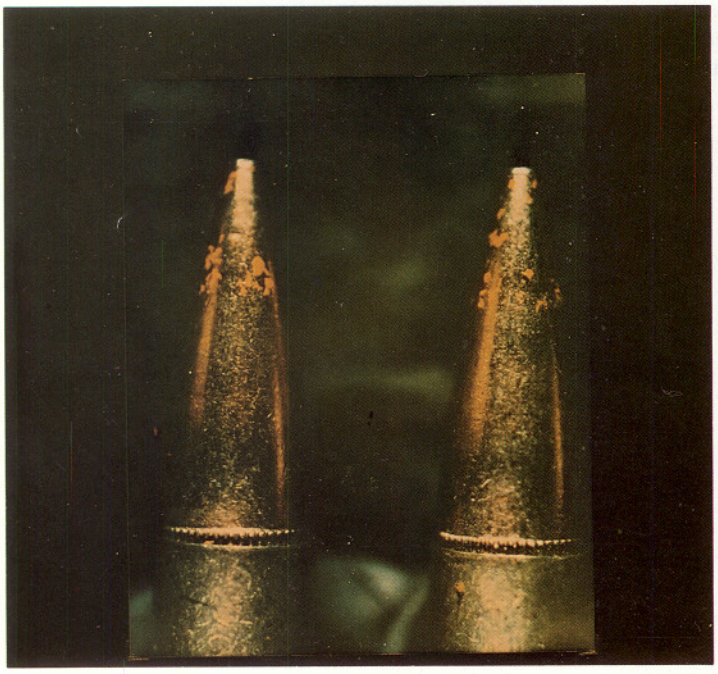
[— — — — — — Permissible — — — — —]



b

[— — — — — — Minor — — — — — —]

Minimum 60% of Original Paint Remains



c

[— — — — — — — Minor — — — — — —]



d

[— — — — — — — Major — — — — — —]

No. 3a. Missing or Partially Missing Paint Identification After Linking

Photographs apply to the Tracer, M62, Overhead Fire, M62, and Armor Piercing, M61, and represent two sides of the same bullet.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T07:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.



a
[Permissible]

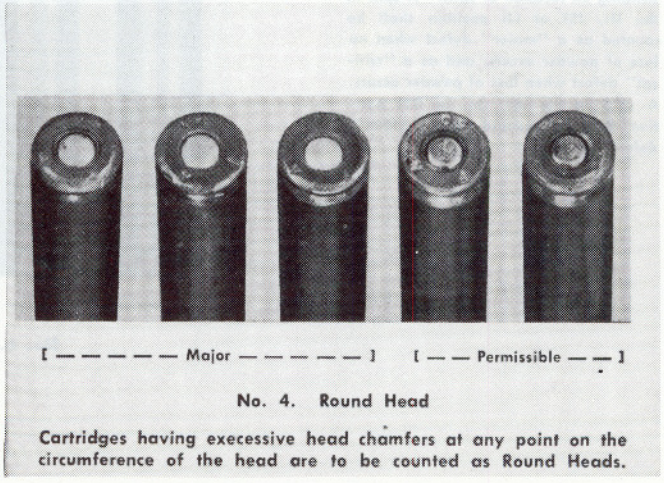


b
[Major]

No. 3b. Identification Missing or Incorrect — Dummy M172

(a) Finish: Black oxide.

(b) Black finish missing or improper.

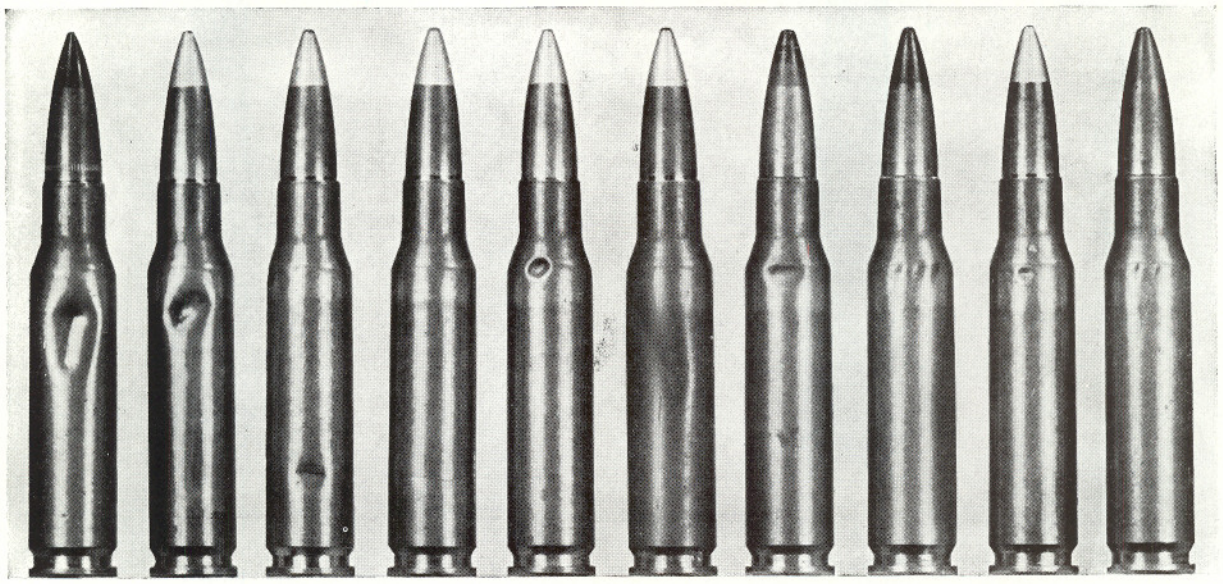


[— — — — — Major — — — — —] [— — Permissible — —]

No. 4. Round Head

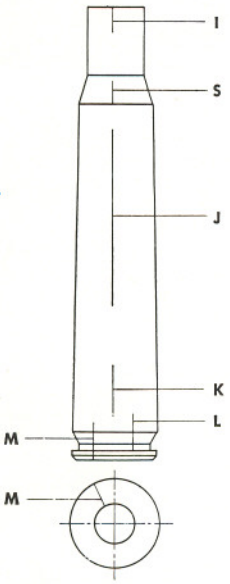
Cartridges having execessive head chamfers at any point on the circumference of the head are to be counted as Round Heads.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T07:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.



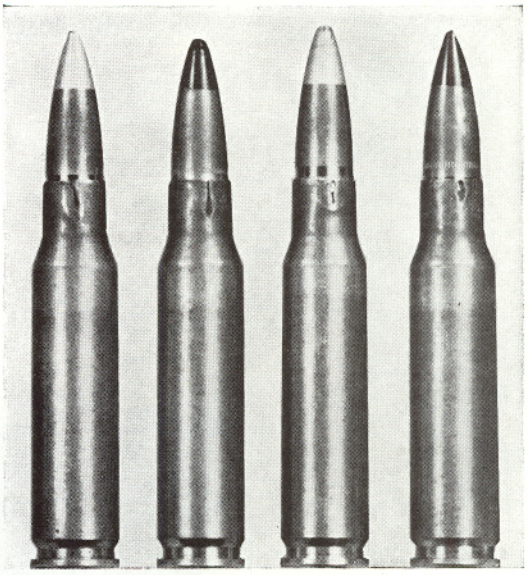
[— — — — — — Major — — — — — —] [— — — — — — — Minor — — — — — — —] [— Permissible —]

No. 5. Dent (case)



A cartridge is to be counted as a defective because of a split case if the cartridge case shows a definite separation of the metal entirely through the case wall.

A cartridge is to be classified either as a "major" or "critical" defective depending on location of split. A split in the (I), (S) or (J) position shall be counted as a "major" defect when no loss of powder occurs; and as a "critical" defect when loss of powder occurs. A split in the (K), (L), or (M) position shall be counted as a "critical" defect.



[— — — — — — Major — — — — — —]

No. 6. Split Case

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T07:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.